

Chapter 32 — "Spot the Pual" Passage Exercise

Num 22–23 · Exo 29 · Isa 43

Each numbered verb belongs to one of the stems you have already studied (Qal, Niphal, Hiphil, Hophal, or Piel/Pual). For each one, fill in: Pual? (Yes/No), Conjugation, PGN, Root, and Stem/Function. The answer key begins on the page marked "Answer Key".

Passage A — Numbers 22:6, 12; 23:8, 20 (Balaam cycle)

22:6

כִּי יֵדַעְתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר תְּבָרֵךְ מִבָּרֵךְ וְאֲשֶׁר תָּאֵר יֹאָר

"...for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	תְּבָרֵךְ				
2	מִבָּרֵךְ				
3	יֹאָר				

22:12

לֹא תֵלֶךְ עִמָּהֶם לֹא תָאֵר אֶת הָעָם כִּי בָרוּךְ הוּא

"You shall not go with them. You shall not curse the people, for they are blessed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	תָּאֵר				
5	בָּרוּךְ				

23:8

מִה אֶקְבֵּה לֹא קִבֵּה אֶל יֹמָה אֲזַעֵם לֹא זָעַם יְהוָה

"How shall I curse what God has not cursed, and how shall I denounce what the LORD has not denounced?"

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	קִבֵּה				
7	זָעַם				

23:20

הִנֵּה בָרַךְ לְקַחְתִּי וְיִבְרַךְ וְלֹא אֲשִׁיבָנָה

"Behold, I have received a command to bless; he has blessed, and I cannot revoke it."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	בָּרַךְ				

Passage B — Exodus 29:36–37 (Consecration of the Altar)

29:36

וּמִשְׁחָתָ אֹתוֹ לְקַדְּשׁוֹ

"...and you shall anoint it to consecrate it."

29:37

שִׁבְעַת יָמִים תִּכְפֹּר עַל הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וּקְדַשְׁתָּ אֹתוֹ וְהָיָה הַמִּזְבֵּחַ קָדֵשׁ קְדָשִׁים כָּל הַנִּגָּע בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ יִקְדָּשׁ

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
10	וְקִדְשָׁתָּ				
11	וְהָיָה				
12	יִקְדָּשׁ				

Passage C — Exodus 14:4; Isaiah 43:23; Exodus 40:17 (Pual of ■■■■ + Hophal distractor)

וּכְבַדְתִּי בַּפֶּרֶעַה וּבְכָל חֵילוֹ

"And I will get glory through Pharaoh and all his host."

Isa 43:23

לֹא כִבַּדְתָּנִי בְּקִרְבָּנֶיךָ

"You have not honored me with your offerings."

Exo 40:17

הַיּוֹקִים הַמִּשְׁכָּן בַּיּוֹם הַחֲדָשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן

"The tabernacle was set up on the first day of the first month."

Reflection Questions

1. In Passage A, verbs 1 (Piel) and 2 (Pual) come from the same root **■ ■ ■ ■**. The root has R2=■, which rejects Dagesh Forte. How does the Pual compensate for the missing dagesh, and why does this make the Pual and Piel of **■ ■ ■ ■** harder to distinguish than strong-root counterparts?
2. Verb 3 (**■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■**, Hophal) and verb 14 (**■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■ ■**, Pual) both express passive meaning. What is the key visual feature that distinguishes a Hophal from a Pual? What does each stem tell you about the corresponding active stem?
3. Verbs 10 (Piel Weqatal) and 12 (Niphal Impf.) from Exo 29:37 use the same root **■ ■ ■ ■**. The priest actively consecrates (Piel); then whatever touches becomes holy (Niphal). How does this passage illustrate the Piel-as-cause / Niphal-as-resulting-state distinction?

Answer Key

Passages with correct answers shown in the green row below each verb.

Passage A — Numbers 22:6, 12; 23:8, 20 (Balaam cycle)

22:6

כִּי יֵדַעְתִּי אֶת אֲשֶׁר תְּבָרֵךְ מִבְּרָכְךָ וְאֲשֶׁר תָּאֵר יֹאֵר

"...for I know that he whom you bless is blessed, and he whom you curse is cursed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
1	תְּבָרֵךְ				see ↓
✓	תְּבָרֵךְ	Imperfect	2ms	בֵּרַךְ	NOT Pual — Piel Intensive: "you bless";
2	מִבְּרָכְךָ				see ↓
✓	מִבְּרָכְךָ	Participle	ms	בֵּרַךְ	Passive — Pual Ptc. ms; Qamets under
3	יֹאֵר				see ↓
✓	יֹאֵר	Imperfect	3ms	אָרַר	NOT Pual — Hophal: "shall be cursed";

22:12

לֹא תֵלֶךְ עִמָּהֶם לֹא תָאֵר אֶת הָעָם כִּי בְרוּךְ הוּא

"You shall not go with them. You shall not curse the people, for they are blessed."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
4	תָּאֵר				see ↓
✓	תָּאֵר	Imperfect	2ms	אָרַר	NOT Pual — Qal: "you shall curse"; no
5	בְּרוּךְ				see ↓
✓	בְּרוּךְ	Participle	ms	בֵּרַךְ	Passive — Pual Ptc. ms (substantial:)

23:8

מִה אֶקְבֵּל לֹא קִבֵּה אֶל יִזְמָה אֲזַעֵם לֹא זָעַם יְהוָה

"How shall I curse what God has not cursed, and how shall I denounce what the LORD has not denounced?"

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
6	קִבֵּה				see ↓
✓	קִבֵּה	Qal Inf.Abs.	—	קִבַּב	NOT Pual — Qal Inf. Abs.; geminate
7	זָעַם				see ↓
✓	זָעַם	Perfect	3ms	זָעַם	NOT Pual — Qal Perf. 3ms;

23:20

הִנֵּה בָרַךְ לְקַחְתִּי וְיִבְרַךְ וְלֹא אֲשִׁיבָנָה

"Behold, I have received a command to bless; he has blessed, and I cannot revoke it."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
8	בָּרַךְ				see ↓
✓	בָּרַךְ	Inf. Absolute	—	בָּרַךְ	NOT Pual — Piel Inf. Abs.: "to bless";

Passage B — Exodus 29:36–37 (Consecration of the Altar)

29:36

וּמִשְׁחָתָּ אֹתוֹ לְקֹדֶשׁ׃

"...and you shall anoint it to consecrate it."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
9	וּמִשְׁחָתָּ				see ↓
✓	וּמִשְׁחָתָּ	Weqatal	2ms	מִשַּׁח	NOT Pual — Qal Weqatal: "and you

29:37

שִׁבְעַת יָמִים תִּכַּפֵּר עַל הַמִּזְבֵּחַ וְקִדַּשְׁתָּ אֹתוֹ וְהָיָה הַמִּזְבֵּחַ קֹדֶשׁ קְדָשִׁים כָּל הַנִּגַּע בַּמִּזְבֵּחַ יִקְדָּשׁ׃

"Seven days you shall make atonement for the altar and consecrate it, and the altar shall be most holy; whatever touches the altar shall be consecrated."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
10	וְקִדַּשְׁתָּ				see ↓
✓	וְקִדַּשְׁתָּ	Weqatal	2ms	קָדַשׁ	NOT Pual — Piel Factitive: "and you
11	וְהָיָה				see ↓
✓	וְהָיָה	Weqatal	3ms	הָיָה	NOT Pual — Qal Weqatal: "and it shall
12	יִקְדָּשׁ׃				see ↓
✓	יִקְדָּשׁ׃	Niphal Impf.	3ms	קָדַשׁ	NOT Pual — Niphal passive/reflexive:

Passage C — Exodus 14:4; Isaiah 43:23; Exodus 40:17 (Pual of ■■■ + Hophal distractor)

Exo 14:4

וְכַבְדְּתִי בַּפָּרֹעַה וּבְכָל חֵילוֹ׃

"And I will get glory through Pharaoh and all his host."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
13	וְכַבְדְּתִי				see ↓
✓	וְכַבְדְּתִי	Weqatal	1cs	כָּבַד	NOT Pual — Niphal reflexive: "I will be

Isa 43:23

לֹא כָבַדְתָּנִי בְּקִרְבָּנֶיךָ׃

"You have not honored me with your offerings."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
14	קִבַּדְתִּנִּי				see ↓
✓	קִבַּדְתִּנִּי	Perfect	2ms	קִבַּד	Passive — Pual: "you have not honored"

Exo 40:17

הוֹקֵם הַמִּשְׁכָּן בְּיוֹם הַחֹדֶשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן

"The tabernacle was set up on the first day of the first month."

#	Verb	Conjugation	PGN	Root	Function
15	הוֹקֵם				see ↓
✓	הוֹקֵם	Perfect	3ms	קָוַם	NOT Pual — Hophal: "was set"